

These cards also allow multiple external connections which is a blessing if you're yet to drop some money on a mixer.

The mixer, as mentioned before is a piece of hardware that serves as a middleman. In this case, it sits between the sound card and the computer. The mixer has multiple inputs and outputs to plug mics and monitors. Each input is routed through a series of knobs that could range from raising or lowering the base volume (gain) to cutting or enhancing specific frequencies or bands of frequencies (equaliser). The sound then flows into what is called a fader and as the name suggests,



The mixer.

raises or lowers the volume or levels that come out of the speakers.

While a mixer really makes things easy, it's nothing more than a glorified mouse. Instead of dumping a ton of money on a mixer, you can spend a fraction of the amount on an additional monitor and place the level control panel on the adjoining screen.

The penultimate component that every studio needs is output. If you call these bad boys speakers, you will be given the worst looks every imagined and it's a dead giveaway that you're a newbie when it comes to audio. The monitors are sometimes the most expensive piece of equipment in a studio. They're called monitors because they are what you use to monitor the sound and they're expensive because they give you a sound that's as flat and as neutral as possible so you can tell if you need to add some magic to it.

You may want to skimp on any other component in your studio, but skimping on the monitors is a big mistake. An additional piece of equipment you need here is a set of headphones. While the quality experienced may not be the same, the headphones are built such that they cancel/block out all external sounds so you can pay close attention to the details of the tracks you're working on.

The final component that every studio must have at hand is the microphone. Different mics behave differently. All mics have a diaphragm, a coil and an a magnet. When sound hits the diaphragm, it vibrates and makes